Connecting ideas

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 4-6 | English

Use connecting words to show how ideas belong together.

Coordinating conjunctions

For, and, nor, but, or, yet, so can join words, phrases, or clauses.

I wanted to play, but it was raining.

Use a comma before the conjunction when it joins two complete sentences.

Subordinating conjunctions

Because, although, if, when, and while begin dependent clauses.

Because it was raining, we played inside.

We played inside because it was raining.

A dependent clause does not usually stand alone as a complete sentence.

Prepositions show relationships

In, on, under, beside, before, after, and with can begin prepositional phrases.

The book is under the desk. We walked after lunch.

Transitions guide the reader

Order: first, next, finally. Example: for instance.

Contrast: however. Cause/result: therefore. Add information: also.

Check the connection

Choose a connector that matches your meaning. Read the sentence to check that the ideas still fit.

OPP